# EXECUTIVE REPORT

This report looks at how four markets moved over the past ten years, from October 2016 to October 2026. The markets are gold (XAUUSD), Bitcoin (BTCUSD), and two currency pairs, AUDCAD and EURAUD. In total there were 11,375 trading days. The main question is simple: do the markets move more on big US news days? The news days we looked at are the NFP jobs report, CPI inflation, and the Fed's FOMC decisions.

The biggest difference between the four is risk. Bitcoin went up 12,833% over the decade, which works out to about 62.6% a year. But at its worst point it dropped 83%. Gold rose 237%, or about 12.9% a year, and its worst drop was 25%. Over the full ten years EURAUD gained just 9.9% and AUDCAD lost 1.1%, so neither really went anywhere. Bitcoin's average daily range is 4.4%, compared with 1.3% for gold and roughly 0.6% to 0.7% for the two currency pairs.

News days are busier, but not by much. On NFP, CPI, and FOMC days, the daily range is about 12% to 15% wider than usual for AUDCAD, Bitcoin, and gold. EURAUD shows no difference at all. Gold reacts most to the Fed: its range is 21% wider on FOMC days and 18% wider on NFP days.

Those wider swings don't turn into bigger moves by the close. Gold's average close-to-close move on FOMC days is 0.56%, compared with 0.74% on normal days. There's also no reliable direction. The best result is a 59% chance of closing higher (Bitcoin on FOMC days, gold on CPI and FOMC days), and that's based on only 80 to 126 days.

The four assets rarely move together. Their correlations sit between -0.03 and +0.11. The one exception is AUDCAD and EURAUD, which move in opposite directions (-0.58) because both contain the Australian dollar. Holding more than one asset helps spread the risk.

As of 10 October 2026, Bitcoin is about 34% below its October 2025 peak, and gold is about 21% below its January 2026 peak.

A few things stand out. Traders should give themselves more room for risk on news days, keep Bitcoin positions small enough to survive an 80% drop, treat gold as the steadier holding, and not trade a direction based on the news alone.

**5**
total event

**4K**
total trading da

**120**
CPI Days

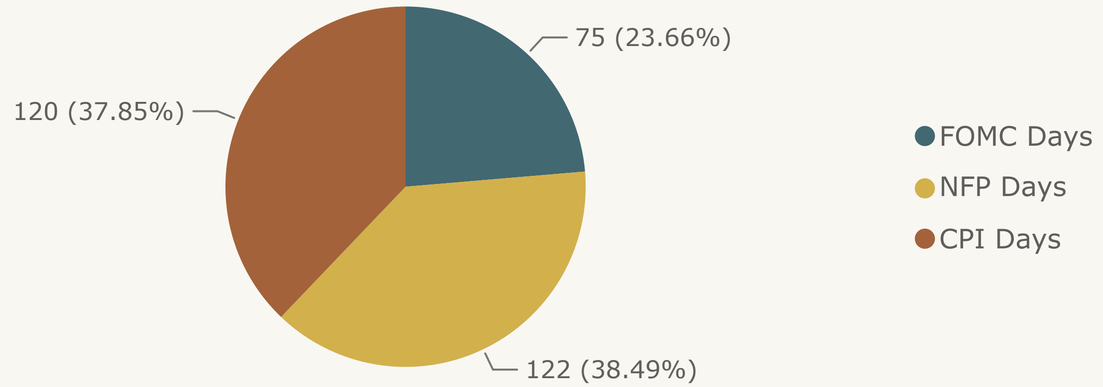
**122**
NFP Days

**75**
FOMC Days

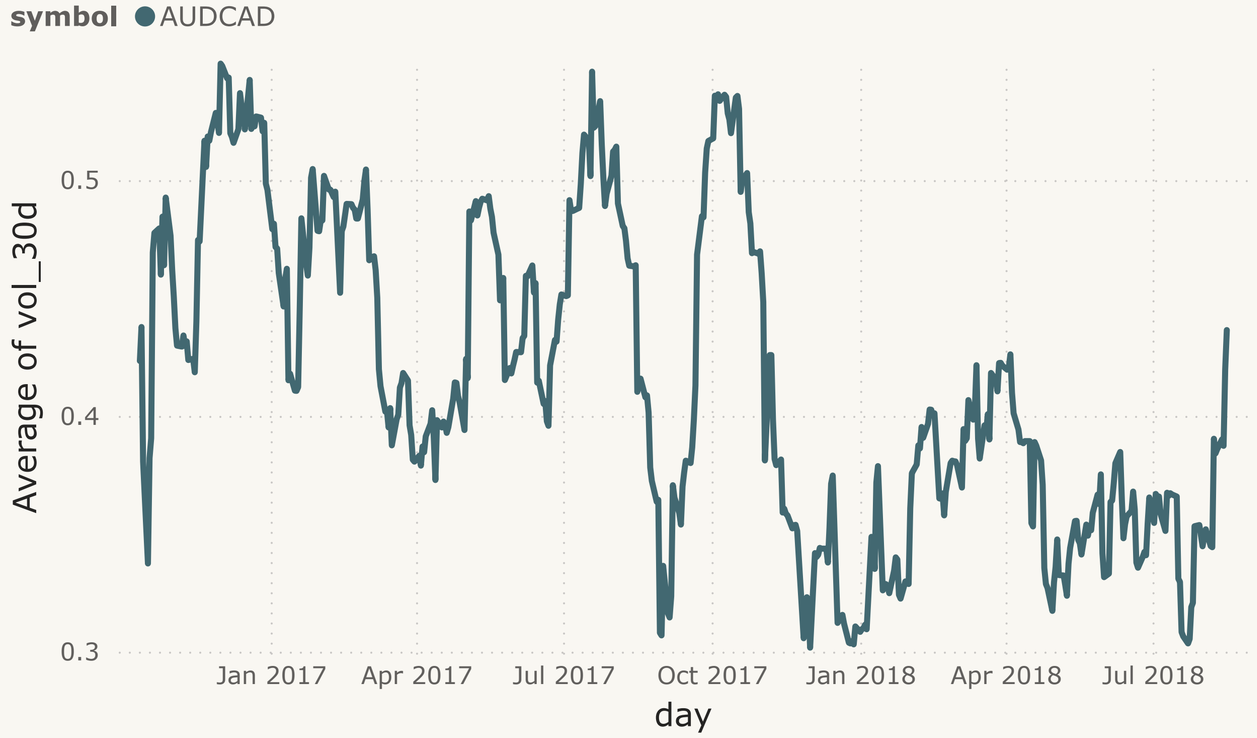
**3K**
None event Days

event_name
- [ ] CPI
- [ ] FOMC
- [ ] NFP
- [ ] None

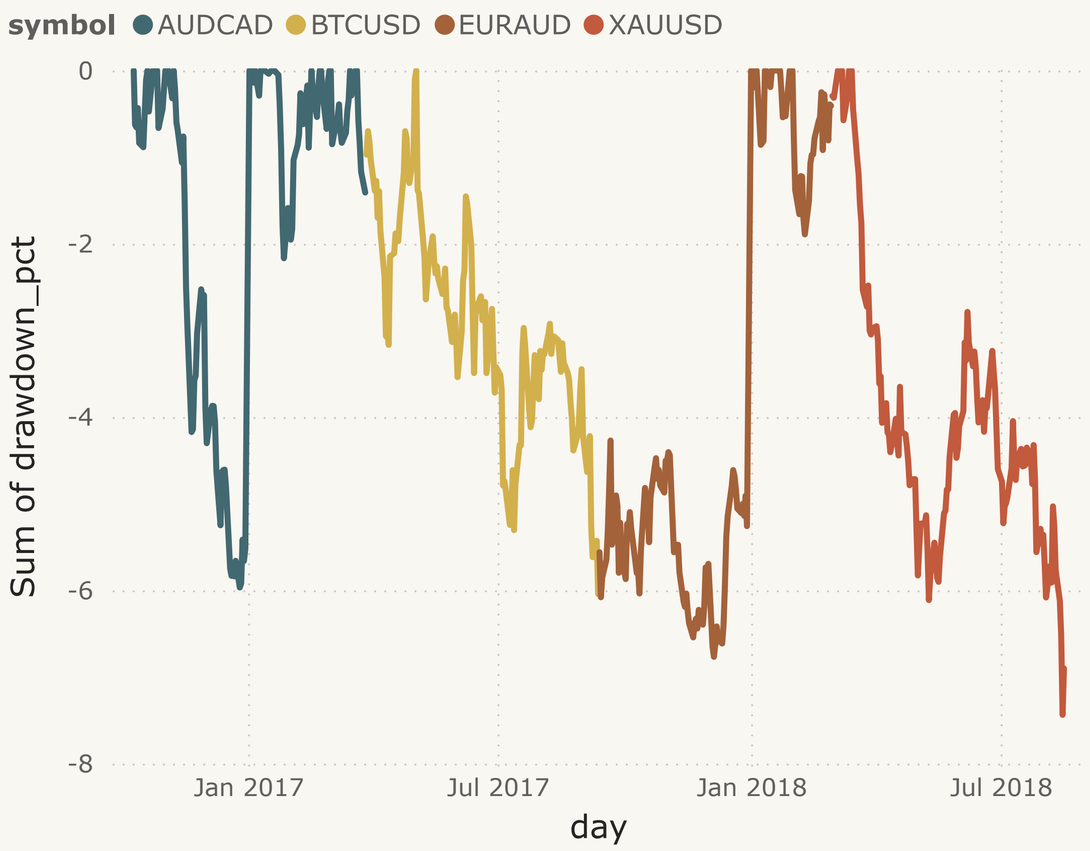
FOMC Days, NFP Days and CPI Days




Average of vol_30d by day and symbol




Sum of drawdown_pct by day and symbol



# KEY INSIGHTS AND RECOMMENDATIONS

*KEY INSIGHTS*

**1. Bitcoin pays the most and hurts the most.**

Bitcoin gained 12,833% over the decade, but at its worst it fell 83% from a previous high. Its average daily range (4.4%) is more than three times gold's (1.3%). Today it sits about 34% below its October 2025 peak. The high reward came with a very bumpy ride.

**2. Gold is the steadier performer.**

Gold gained 237% (12.9% a year). Its return for the risk taken (Sharpe 0.80) is second only to Bitcoin's (1.07), and its worst fall was 25%, in July 2026. It is now about 21% below its January 2026 peak.

**3. News days are wider, but not wilder by the close.**

Daily ranges are 12% to 15% wider on news days for gold, Bitcoin, and AUDCAD. Gold reacts most to the Fed (21% wider on FOMC days, 18% on NFP days), while EURAUD barely notices. But the final move isn't bigger: gold moves 0.56% on FOMC days against 0.74% on a normal day. News makes the day noisier, not necessarily more decisive.

**4. There's no reliable direction on news days.**

The best readings are Bitcoin closing higher on 59% of FOMC days and gold on 59% of CPI and FOMC days. AUDCAD closes higher on only 40% of NFP days. With only 80 to 126 days behind each figure, gaps this small could easily be luck.

**5. The assets rarely move together.**

Gold and Bitcoin have a correlation of just 0.11, and the currency pairs are close to unrelated to both. The one strong link is AUDCAD and EURAUD at -0.58, because both contain the Australian dollar on opposite sides. Holding gold and Bitcoin spreads risk, but holding both Australian dollar pairs mostly cancels itself out.

**Recommendations**

**1. Give yourself more room on news days.**

Plan for 10% to 20% wider swings on NFP, CPI, and FOMC days, especially in gold. Use wider stops and smaller position sizes on those days. EURAUD needs no special treatment.

**2. Don't trade a direction from the news alone.**

A 59% win rate over a few dozen days is not an edge. Use the news calendar to manage risk, not to decide whether to buy or sell.

**3. Size Bitcoin for the worst case.**

An 83% fall has already happened once. Decide in advance how much loss you can live with, and keep the position small enough that a repeat wouldn't force you out of the market.

**4. Use gold as the steady core.**

Gold gave 12.9% a year with about a quarter of Bitcoin's volatility, and it barely moves with Bitcoin (correlation 0.11). Pair the two instead of choosing one.

**5. Test the next question before trading it.**

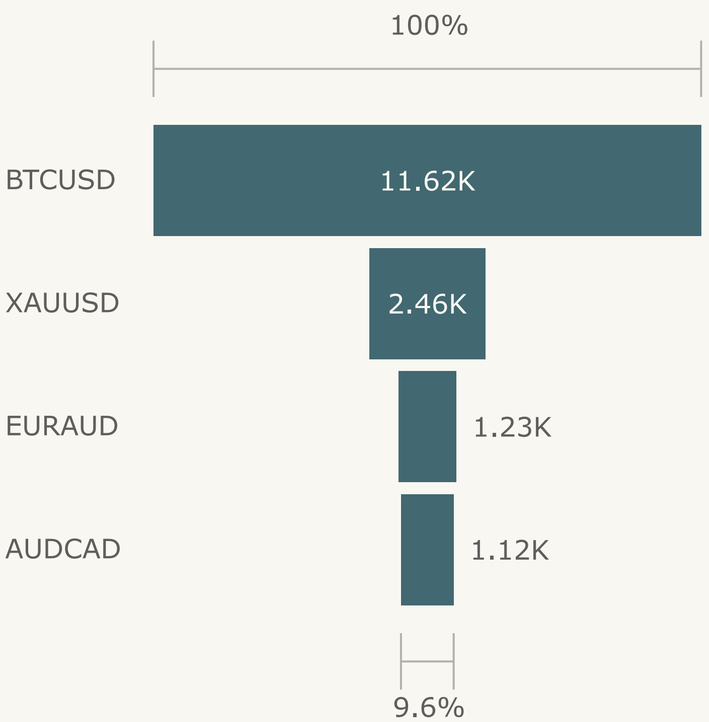
Two ideas are worth checking: how prices react in the first hours after a release (hourly data), and whether the surprise (actual versus forecast) matters more than the release itself. Seasonality is worth watching too: Bitcoin averaged +16% in October (up in 8 of 11 years), and June was weak for both Bitcoin (-4%) and gold (-1.9%). With only about ten observations per month, treat it as a watch list, not a rule.

| symbol | CPI | None | **Total** |
|---|---|---|---|
| AUDCAD | 52.46 | 584.53 | **636.9** |
| **Total** | **52.46** | **584.53** | **636.9** |

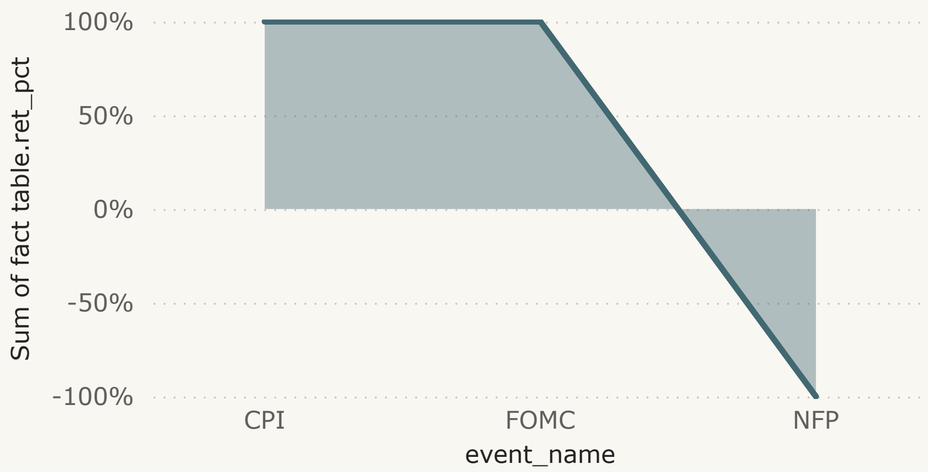
symbol

- [ ] (Blank)
- [ ] AUDCAD
- [ ] BTCUSD
- [ ] EURAUD
- [ ] XAUUSD

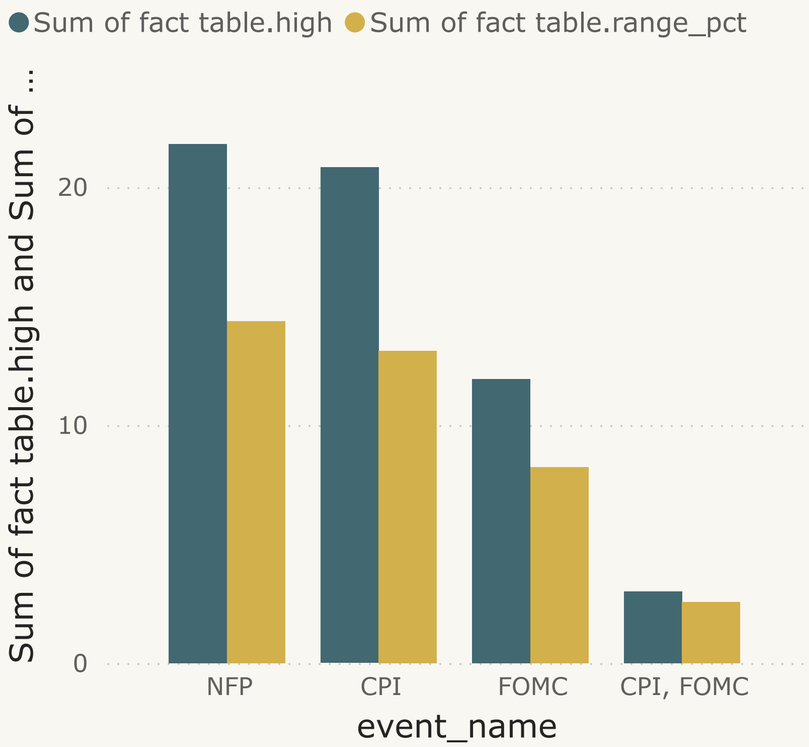
## Sum of vol_30d by symbol



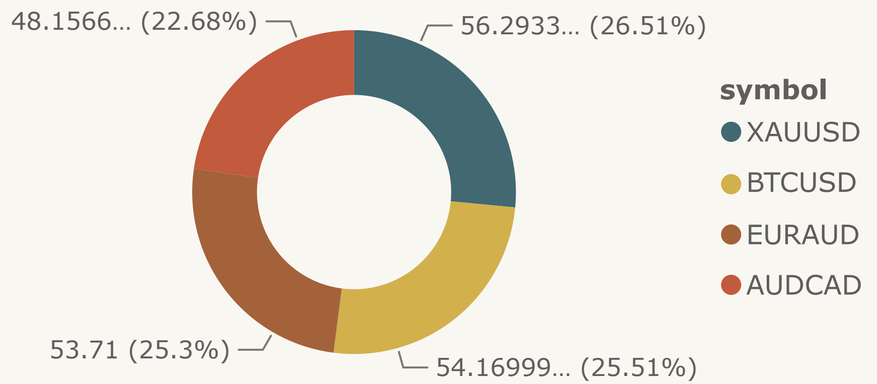

## Sum of fact table.ret_pct by event_name




## Sum of fact table.high and Sum of fact table.range_pct by event_name




## Average of win_rate_pct by symbol




## Average of win_rate_pct by event_name

